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Tentative S.F. Strike Pact; Pickets Remain

Ratification By Unions Awaited

A tentative agreement ending the three-day-old strike of San Francisco city employes was reached today.

However pickets were to remain at various city facilities except the Municipal Railway until the five striking unions ratified the settlement late this afternoon.

John Jeffery, executive secretary of the 3,300-member City and County Employes Union Local 400, said the major provisions of the package of pay raises to be voted on include:

1. Restoration of the annual increment raises for underfour-year employes. This was a major strike issue.

2. A general cost-of-living increase of 5 to 6 per cent for all employes except health inspectors and parking meter repairmen, a total of 80 to 90 persons. No explanation of the inspectors and repairmen omissions was given.

3. Restoration of the 15 per cent wage differential for city-employed nurses over nurses in private hospitals.

Jeffery said his union would meet at 5 p.m. to vote on the settlement.

The Board of Supervisors was to receive the proposal at 2 p.m. and Mayor Joseph L. Alioto said he would recommend its adoption "with my blessing."

He announced the agreement shortly after 9 a.m. following a nonstop negotiating session lasting nearly 18 hours.

Flanked by Jeffery and George Johns, secretary of the San Francisco Labor Council, Alioto called the agreement "a settlement with which all San Franciscans can live." He said it "insures peace in this city."

The mayor told the assembled newsmen, union members and curious conventioneers in the lobby of Del Webb's Townehouse that during the strike he had been urged many times to call out the National Guard and summon the U.S. Corps of Engineers to operate the sewer system.

He refused, he said, because if he had done so, "we would have had blood running in the streets."

Asked if the new pay package would increase property taxes, Alioto said yes, but quickly pointed out that only half the city salaries come from this source.

Alioto termed the settlement "reasonable and responsible," but Jeffery was not so enthusiastic. He said he was "not altogether pleased."

Later, he said the union committee "voted reluctantly" to recommend its acceptance by the unions.

The mayor said he would go into explicit details of the proposal when it was presented to the supervisors.

He noted that the settlement, if approved, would cost the city substantially less than the $9.5 million asked by the unions.

But it was well above the $4.8 million offered by the city.

A city official later estimated the cost at around $6 million.

Meanwhile, city services were still in a state of upheaval.

• Pickets were at hospitals, schools, city hall and other installations.

The Municipal Railway got off to a faltering start, but expected to approach normal service by day's end.

Schools were open and operating, with a number of parents volunteering as room monitors. Many, unsure of the strike status, kept their children at home.

General Hospital continued on emergency status only as nurses swelled the ranks of

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UNION LEADER JOHN JEFFERY, MAYOR ALIOTO AND GEORGE JOHNS
Trio announced tentative settlement of San Francisco municipal strike

Israeli Troops Raid Syria, Keep Pressure on Suez Area

By RAYMOND LAWRENCE
Foreign News Analyst

Israel's forces, in the latest acceleration of the Middle East fighting, struck into Syria twice during the night.

In the deepest penetration into that country since the 1967 war, the Israeli shelled an enemy armed camp and blew up a big power line 12 miles from Damascus, the capital.

An Israeli spokesman said the raiders also blew up a bridge and two gun positions south of Damascus. The command did not say how the raids were made but observers assumed the commandos were carried by helicopters, the same method used for deep penetrations into Egypt.

Later, Israeli drove into southern Syria near the Jordanian border where they blasted a culvert across the military road and blew up three Syrian pillboxes.

The Israeli spokesman said the full damage of the raids was not known but he assumed Damascus was without electricity.

Today Israeli and Egyptian jets battled over the Suez Canal area. The Tel Aviv spokesman said a MIG21 was shot down and another hit over the central part of the waterway. Israel says it has downed 89 aircraft since the 1967 war — 76 Egyptian and 17 Syrian.

Cairo claimed Egyptian jet interceptors attacked three waves of Israeli planes and one was shot down.

On the diplomatic front the Japanese news service Kyodo reported the United States and the Soviet Union have agreed on a temporary embargo on arms supplies to Israel and the Arab countries.

The dispatch quoted informed sources in Beirut, Lebanon, and said the agreement pertained to additional arms.

The supposed purpose is to prepare the way for U.N. special envoy Gunnar Jarring to resume his efforts to bring the two sides together, as proposed by U.N. Secretary General Thant.

Thus, the United States would hold off selling Israel additional jets — a decision President Nixon has been delaying for weeks.

Israel's Ambassador Yitzhak Rabin in New York to Washington today after four days of consultation in Tel Aviv about this delay on the deal for 110 more Phantoms and Skyhawks.

Thus, Jerusalem newspapers speculated yesterday that Nixon had decided against the sale pending outcome of diplomatic discussions on the Middle East. Other reports said the delay was due to fear of provoking the Soviet Union.

And now for a comment:

The raids deep into Syria probably are intended to deter the Syrians from further provocations. Israel pointed out that since Jan. 1 of this year Syria has made 148 attacks on the border, which is twice as many as for the same period in 1969. In the worst one in the Israeli-occupied Golan Heights two Israeli soldiers were killed and 13 wounded.

The Japanese Kyodo report is suspect. Beirut, like so many Arab centers, is a fruitful source of irresponsible rumors, and there are no specific sources for this particular news story.

But there is here a germ of an acceptable interpretation. Nixon does appear to be withholding a sale—not a gift as in the case of Soviet aid to the Arabs—of more jets to Israel in hope that such action may induce the Russians to accede to some kind of an agreement. The Jerusalem Post, which often speaks for the government, may be right when it says:

"The new American thinking is said to envisage a package deal that would link the future supply of additional planes with Israel's agreement in principle to far-reaching border changes, as well as concessions on the Arab refugee issue."

Confused Muni Shoots For Rush Hour Service

Municipal Railway service was partially restored today and "some semblance" of service was to be on the streets in time for evening rush hour. This followed a morning of confusion over whether San Francisco's city employes were still on strike.

The rush hour service was not expected to be "100 per cent," according to Robert Rockwell, Muni director of public relations. Full service could not be provided until tomorrow, he said, because of problems in getting drivers and maintenance forces back on the job.

Rail and bus service started, then stopped, then finally started again as pickets disappeared, reappeared, then vanished again at some Muni yards.

At about 6:30 a.m. a spokesman from the mayor's office informed Muni Asst. Transportation Supt. Carl Barton that the "strike had been settled." That was 2½ hours before the official announcement.

Barton immediately issued orders to call motormen, drivers and shopmen. By 7:30 a.m. at least three streetcars and a few buses were on the street.

They were quickly recalled when it was apparent the strike was, in fact, not over. Pickets appeared at some Muni division yards. By 7:30 a.m. they had disappeared, then returned by mid-morning.

However, the pickets did not return to all Muni divisions. As an example, nurses picketed the Washington and Mason streets cable car barn while no pickets were evident at Kirkland Division about a mile away near Fisherman's Wharf.

"We are all ready to roll," said a Muni supervisor at Kirkland. "We are just waiting for the word."

Busing Plea Shunned by High Court

Compiled from AP and UPI

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court declined unanimously today to speed school desegregation in Charlotte, N.C., via a massive busing plan.

The court gave no explanation as it rejected a request by civil rights lawyers for reinstatement of the busing order, entered Feb. 5 by Judge James B. McMillan but stayed March 5 by an appeals court.

In other actions today, the court:

—Unanimously upheld a settlement of an antitrust suit in which the government had charged the nation's biggest auto makers with conspiring to delay and obstruct development of auto air-pollution devices.

—Recorded Chief Justice Warren E. Burger as supporting a loyalty oath for public employes in Massachusetts.

Despite complaints by New York and other big cities, it reffirmed a Los Angeles judge's decree requiring automobile manufacturers to compete in developing antipollution devices.

The rare setback for blacks, who have been consistently successful in pleas to the high court, probably means schools in the Charlotte—Mecklenburg district will not be subject to deeper desegregation this school year.

The dispute is scheduled to be argued before the U.S. Circuit Court in Richmond, Va., April 9.

Judge McMillan's busing plan would have added at least 14,000 students to the 23,000 children already bused to school in Charlotte.

They would have crisscrossed the city in a school-pairing arrangement, averaging up to two and a half hours a day in transit.

School officials had told the court they don't have the money to buy the buses that would be needed.

Prior to today's ruling, the Supreme Court has methodically cut down efforts to delay desegregation. In this term it ordered full speed ahead in 30 Mississippi districts, 14 additional Southern districts, in Oklahoma City, and last Monday in Memphis.

The NAACP Legal Defense and Educational Fund had accused Charlotte school officials of open defiance of desegregation orders.

Fund officials had said that unless federal district judges like McMillan are upheld on appeal there was little likelihood that the rights of black children to attend integrated schools, which were first declared by the Supreme Court in 1954, will be little more than an unrealized ideal.

The motion to reinstate Judge McMillan's busing order was presented to Chief Justice Warren E. Burger last week, since he has jurisdiction over federal courts in North Carolina.

Burger turned the request over to the court conference, which discussed the issue at a hastily scheduled secret conference last Friday. The motion was denied this morning in a one-sentence ruling.

In the antipollution case, the court acted in a brief order, without opinion.

The Justice Department and the oil companies together worked out the decree, entered Oct. 23, 1969, by Federal District Judge Jesse W. Curtis. The "consent judgment" eliminated the need for a trial.

The civil suit was started by the department against the Automobile Manufacturers Association and General Motors, Ford, Chrysler and American Motors on Jan. 10, 1969. The defendants were charged with violating the Sherman antitrust law to eliminate all competition among themselves both in purchase of patents and in installation of air pollution control equipment on cars. The complaint asked for a ban on certain specific practices.

The judgment, among other things, requires an end to a 1953 cross-licensing agreement and bans any combination to restrain development of anti-pollution devices.

CAPT. DONALD A. SWANN
Victim of mutiny

U.S. Radar Base Wiped Out in Laos

WASHINGTON (AP) — North Vietnamese troops annihilated a small American force operating a secret radar installation hidden in a limestone cave atop a mountain in Laos, killing at least 12 U.S. servicemen, The Washington Post reported today.

The Americans died March 11, 1968, the Post said, defending the radar, reconnaissance and rescue base. The site contained highly sophisticated electronic gear for directing bombing raids along the Ho Chi Minh Trail and over North Vietnam, the report added.

In a Vientiane dateline dispatch by T. D. Allman, the story said the defeat suffered at the hands of the North Vietnamese was kept a secret.

The Defense Department made no comment on the report.

Over the weekend, however, White House Press Secretary Ronald L. Ziegler disclosed there were "some" U.S. casualties in Laos since 1962 besides the earlier confirmed death of Army Capt. Joseph K. Bush Jr. Ziegler declined to state the exact number of American military personnel who had died as a result of hostile fire, saying only that it was "less than 50."

According to the Post, the base was called Phou Pha Thi and was located on a 3,860-foot peak in northeastern Laos about 15 miles from the North Vietnam frontier.

Radar nets dotted nearby hills and Air Force and Central Intelligence Agency personnel used the valley landing strip as a base for American-led teams of Meo tribesmen entering North Vietnam on harassment missions, the Post said.

Highly sophisticated electronic gear was housed in a limestone cave and used to electronically release bombs and guide planes to targets over North Vietnam, the report said.

Helicopters also reportedly used the base for rescuing flyers downed in North Vietnam.

Two ground attacks failed to dislodge the troops, the Post continued, and in early 1968 Soviet-made biplanes attempted an air raid on the base.

The old AN2s, however, were no match for the American helicopters that went aloft. Servicemen firing M-16 rifles shot down two of the North Vietnamese Air Force planes, the report said.

The North Vietnamese finally overran the air strip and fought their way up the side of the mountain, the Post continued, finally overrunning the base.

One American was quoted as saying the American and Meo troops "fought to the last man. They were all killed March 11 inside that grotto. An enormous amount of equipment was lost, too."

Sources familiar with the base, the Post said, estimated American deaths at between 12 and 21, mostly U.S. Air Force personnel. A number of Laotian officers and about 100 Meo tribesmen also perished, the report stated.

The Pathet Lao reportedly broadcast in March, 1968, that it was attacking Lima Site, the mountain installation.

Ammo Ship Mutineers Get Asylum

Compiled from AP and UPI

The Cambodian government has notified the United States it has granted asylum to two Americans who hijacked the freighter Columbia Eagle, the State Department said today in Washington.

Cambodia's foreign office at Phnom Penh also notified the U.S. charge D'Affaires, Lloyd Rives, that the ship, loaded with bombs, was being taken over and moved to the port of Sihanoukville.

The names of the crew members who engineered the hijack, apparently with a fake bomb threat, were not immediately disclosed.

Lives was told by the Cambodian government that the decision regarding disposition of the ship, its cargo and the remaining 13 crew members would be made later.

The cargo consists of 500-pound and 750-pound bombs and other munitions bound for Sattahip, Thailand.

The State Department's press officer, Robert J. McCloskey, said this afternoon, "We have since learned that Cambodian officials boarded the vessel and have taken off the two who requested asylum. And that's the state of the matter now."

McCloskey stressed that a "reported mutiny" had occurred. He said the department did not have enough information to determine precisely what happened.

McCloskey said Lives would press for the release of the ship, its cargo and all crew members who wish to leave Cambodia.

Defense Department spokesman Jerry Friedheim said "We don't know if the Cambodian seizure of the Columbia Eagle." Donald A. Swann, 51, Portland, Ore., is now in charge of his vessel.

The Pentagon stressed that its information is sketchy and may not be accurate in all respects.

The word came from what Friedheim termed "Defense Department sources," presumably the U.S. Coast Guard cutter which has been stationed off Sihanoukville since the mutineers took over the Columbia Eagle during the weekend.

The Pentagon later confirmed for the first time that

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Reds Defy Cambodia, Stay On

Compiled from AP and UPI

SAIGON — Cambodia's deadline for withdrawal of North Vietnamese and Viet Cong forces passed yesterday without any sign of compliance. North Vietnamese and Cambodian troops were reported to have exchanged fire for four hours just before the deadline.

More than 20,000 Cambodian youths marched before the National Assembly building in Phnom Penh, the Cambodian capital, renewing the public's demand that Vietnamese Communist troops leave the country. The crowd dispersed quietly after an hour of speeches denouncing the North Vietnamese and Viet Cong.

Representatives of the Cambodian Assembly and government met with representatives of the North Vietnamese in Phnom Penh for three hours. But Hanoi broadcasts in advance of the meeting made no specific mention of troop withdrawals, saying instead that problems caused by the anti-Vietnamese rioting last week would be taken up.

The reported clash was the first of any size ever reported between Cambodian troops and the thousands of North Vietnamese and Viet Cong who for years have maintained bases just across the Cambodian-South Vietnamese border to escape American and South Vietnamese attack.

Associated Press correspondent Peter Arnett reported from a South Vietnamese

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22 Yanks Killed as Spy Plane Crashes

Compiled from AP and UPI

DA NANG, Vietnam — A four-engine U.S. Navy electronic spy plane with 31 Americans aboard crashed as it was landing at this sprawling air base today and exploded in a huge ball of flames.

Twenty-two of the plane's crew were killed, while nine others were injured, as were two Air Force men on the ground, military spokesmen said. The spokesmen said the crash "was apparent mechanical failure."

The plane crashed into a large Air Force maintenance hangar, destroying it and an F4 Phantom jet parked nearby, and damaging a second Phantom.

The plane was an EC121 Superconstellation, a prop-driven craft packed with advanced electronic gear which monitors radio and radar transmissions from the planes and ships over international waters off enemy coasts. This was the type of plane that a North Korean MiG shot down last April, killing all 22 men aboard.

U.S. spokesmen refused to discuss where the plane had been flying today.

The chute broke in two on impact. Only the white tail section and part of the fuselage were distinguishable amid the scattered wreckage.

Debris from the plane heavily damaged a nearby hut used as a makeshift snack bar for mechanics on alert status at the air base.

It was one of the worst air disasters of the Vietnam war involving American troops. The heaviest toll of American lives was recorded on Jan. 25, 1966, when a C123 transport plane crashed near An Khe, 240 miles northeast of Saigon, killing 46 U.S. servicemen.

U.S. spokesmen said the EC121 crashed about 300 yards east of the runway near a busy road leading to a large American mess hall.

Some of the wreckage ripped into a backstop on a softball field near the hangar, but the field was deserted.

The plane also missed a row of revetments concealing eight-million-dollar jet aircraft.

small world

ELECTION YEAR

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